the sight of the **verdant** bowl. Here was water to be had, and so close to his holding! Forgetting all tiredness, he raced home and brought out his pickaxe and spade and soon the buffaloes' picnic spot was a perfectly decent little pond.

"Is this story going to end with a moral?" you ask me **suspiciously**. No, little one, but there is something to learn from everything we see and hear; so hush, while I come to end of the tale.

So happy was the farmer that he told his wife who **summoned** the village priest to bless their **fortune**. I do not need to tell you how soon news travels in a little village and so it was quite a crowd that gathered by the side of the pond to see the priest furrow his brow and chant serious something that nobody ever understands.

Just then, the richest farmer in the village pushed his way to the front of the group. He was always upset when things took place that he was not invited to. Looking at the farmer and the placid pond, a slow smile of **contentment** creased his face. "I see you have come to bless my pond," he said to the priest. "Your pond?" **stuttered** the poor farmer. "Why yes," smoothly oiled the rich one. "Your patch, surely, ends just there. This land is all mine." And saying this he crossed his arms and planted his feet **four-square** on the ground. As the rich farmer and the poor one looked at each other, the buffaloes, the dogs, the boar and yes, even the little bird stopped by to see. They all stood around the little jewel of blue and in every mind, small and big, came a similar thought: "Surely, I had something to do with this!"

And so I end with a question to you, my beloved friend.

"Who owns the water?" Not a moral, just a thought – a germ of an idea to dig and make bigger.

Answer the following questions in one or two sentences.

1. Why did the farmer have to travel far?
2. What sight made the farmer thankful?
3. Name the tools the farmer brought out. What did he do with them?
4. Why did the crowd gather by the side of the pond?
5. When did the richest farmer get upset? Why?

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GLOSSARY

verdant	- green with grass	contentment	- satisfaction
suspiciously	- doubtfully	stuttered	- spoke with difficulty
summoned	- called	four-square	- solidly
fortune	- luck		

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